THE SOLUTION · RESEARCH REPORT

FROM TRANSFER TO ONE STATE

Every major proposal for ending the Israeli–Palestinian conflict, ordered from one extreme to the other: terms, legality, public support, feasibility as of November 2026, and what each means for a game with multiple endgames.



Israeli sovereignty over all the land Partition and shared arrangements A single state for all, or a Palestinian state over all the land

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Scope Proposals documented in scholarly, legal, policy and press sources, presented descriptively. Inclusion is not endorsement.

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ISRAELI SOVEREIGNTY OVER ALL THE LAND		
01	**Population transfer / "encouraged emigration"**	Palestinians leave the West Bank and/or Gaza, by agreement, incentive or force (Peel 1937 exchange idea, Moledet, post-2023 Gaza emigration schemes, the 2025 "Gaza Riviera").
02	**Annexation without equal rights**	Israel annexes the territories. Palestinians get residency or local self-rule without a national vote (Smotrich's 2017 Decisive Plan).
03	**Annexation with citizenship**	Israel annexes the West Bank and phases in citizenship for its Palestinians, usually excluding Gaza and refugee return (Glick, Elitzur, Hotovely, Rivlin).
ISRAELI CONTROL, LIMITED PALESTINIAN SELF-RULE		
04	**Autonomy**	Self-government over people with sovereignty left open (the Allon Plan 1967, Begin 1977, the Camp David framework 1978).
05	**Enclaves and emirates**	Israel annexes Area C or most of the West Bank; Palestinians govern city islands or clan-run "emirates" (Bennett 2012, Smotrich's 82% map, Kedar, the 2025 Hebron proposal).
06	**Jordanian option**	Jordan takes responsibility for West Bank Palestinians (the London Agreement 1987, "Jordan is Palestine"). Jordan has rejected this since 1988.
07	**Conflict management**	No final settlement: a security-led status quo, "shrinking the conflict", economic peace and regional normalisation around an unresolved core.
PARTITION		
08	**Three-state solution**	Gaza linked to Egypt and the West Bank to Jordan (Bolton 2009, Eiland's land swaps), or two separate Palestinian entities, as entrenched since 2007.
09	**Conditional statehood (Trump 2020)**	A state with restricted sovereignty, Israeli control of the Jordan Valley and settlements, conditions judged by Israel and the US.
10	**Negotiated two states**	The 1967 lines with roughly 2–7% swaps, Jerusalem divided by neighbourhood, a special regime for the holy sites, a non-militarised Palestine, and refugee return mainly to Palestine (Clinton, Taba, Geneva, Olmert, Kerry).
11	**Regional and multilateral track**	Statehood paired with Arab normalisation and recognition from outside the region (the Arab Peace Initiative, the 2025 New York Declaration, about 157 recognitions).
SHARED AND LAYERED SOVEREIGNTY		
12	**Confederation**	Two sovereign states with open borders, residency separate from citizenship, and joint institutions (A Land for All; the Beilin–Husseini Holy Land Confederation).

13	**Jordanian–Palestinian confederation**	A Palestinian state linked to Jordan. Amman accepts this only after statehood (the 1985 Hussein–Arafat accord, the 2018 revival).
14	**Federation, cantons or parallel states**	One federal framework with ethnic or territorial units (canton plans; LeVine and Mossberg's "parallel states").
15	**International trusteeship**	International administration of contested areas: the 1947 Jerusalem corpus separatum, a special regime for the Holy Basin, and the 2025 Board of Peace and stabilisation force for Gaza.
●	**ONE STATE OVER ALL THE LAND**	
16	**The one-state reality (baseline)**	A description of today, not a proposal: one power rules from the river to the sea with unequal rights (Lustick; Barnett, Brown, Lynch and Telhami). Every endgame departs from it.
17	**Binational state**	Political parity between two nations in one polity (Brit Shalom, Ihud, the 1947 UNSCOP minority federal plan).
18	**One democratic state with full return**	Equal citizenship with refugee return and restitution (Said, Judt, Abunimah, the One Democratic State Campaign).
19	**Palestinian/Arab state with limited or no rights for Jews**	Palestinian sovereignty over all the land with Jewish presence limited or removed (the 1968 PLO Charter, the 1988 Hamas Charter, the 2021 "Promise of the Hereafter" conference).

Ordering by the editors for game-design purposes. Placement describes each proposal's structure, not its merit, legality or likelihood; several proposals at both ends would involve serious violations of international law, as discussed in the relevant sections.

Law, demography and vetoes narrow every endgame

As of November 2026, every long-term proposal for the Israeli–Palestinian conflict is blocked by at least one actor with a veto, from population transfer and annexation without rights at the Israeli-maximalist pole to a Palestinian state with limited or no rights for Jews at the opposite pole. The proposals with the largest popular constituencies are the ones that breach international law. Only the negotiated two-state band fits the legal anchors set by UN Security Council Resolutions 242 and 2334 and the International Court of Justice's July 2024 advisory opinion. Its terms are the 1967 lines with about 2–7% land swaps, Jerusalem divided by neighbourhood with a special regime for the holy sites, a non-militarised Palestine, and refugee return mainly to Palestine. This band has gained diplomatic weight: about 157 states recognise Palestine, and the General Assembly endorsed the New York Declaration 142–10. Yet only 16–27% of Israeli Jews support it, the Israeli government rejects Palestinian statehood, and record settlement growth plus the February 2026 West Bank land-registration decisions are eroding its territorial basis. At the Israeli end, 42% of Israeli Jews backed annexation without equal rights in 2024, and transfer has entered party platforms, although both breach the Fourth Geneva Convention and the bar on acquiring territory by force and both face vetoes from Washington, Cairo, Amman and the Gulf. At the Palestinian end, about a third of Palestinians back a Palestinian-dominated state in which Jews lack full rights; that outcome presupposes Israel's military defeat and would itself require expulsion or disenfranchisement. Confederation, federation, trusteeship and one democratic state are minority options everywhere except among Arab citizens of Israel. A short list of variables separates the endgames: near-parity of about 7.4–7.8 million Jews and "others" and 7.4 million Palestinians between the river and the sea; the franchise given to Palestinians; the fate of about 750,000 settlers; refugee return; holy-site sovereignty; security control; and the consent of veto players, starting with the hung 53–48–19 Knesset elected on 27 October 2026. For "The

Solution", the evidence argues for starting the game in the current hybrid of de facto West Bank annexation, Israeli control of most of Gaza behind the "Yellow Line" and a stalled international transition, and treating every named endgame as a departure from that default.

The November 2026 baseline: near-parity, an illegality ruling and a hung Knesset

Every proposal below would have to be implemented on top of the same facts. The table collects the indicators a designer needs to set up the opening game state. The paragraphs after it add the legal and political context.

Indicator	Value (date)	Source and attribution
Israel's population	10.305 million (Sept 2026): about 7.8 million Jews and "others" (78.3%) and nearly 2.2 million Arabs (21.7%); includes East Jerusalem Palestinians and settlers	CBS via i24NEWS
Palestinians in the 1967 territories	West Bank including East Jerusalem 3.43 million; Gaza 2.13 million (end-2025)	PCBS
River-to-sea balance	About 7.8 million Jews and others against about 7.4 million Palestinians in historic Palestine (15.5 million Palestinians worldwide); East Jerusalem is double-counted if CBS and PCBS figures are added together	Arab News/PCBS
Annexation arithmetic	Annexing the West Bank would make almost 40% of Israel's residents Palestinian; close to half if Gaza were included	INSS Memo 217
Settlers	541,085 in the West Bank outside East Jerusalem (1 Jan 2026, pro-settlement registry); 230,000–340,000 Israelis in East Jerusalem depending on definition; more than 750,000 in total (EU)	JVL; EEAS
Settlement growth, 2025	54 new settlements approved, 86 new outposts, 27,941 housing units advanced (Peace Now; other tallies give 41 settlements)	Peace Now
Area C	About 60% of the West Bank, under full Israeli control; 150,000–300,000 Palestinians live there (estimates conflict)	OCHA; Wikipedia
Gaza territory	Israel controls or restricts 53–70% depending on source; about 2.1 million people live in roughly a third of the Strip; 82% of structures damaged	Al Jazeera
Gaza deaths	74,594 killed by 31 Oct 2026, including about 1,580 since the October 2025 ceasefire (Gaza Ministry of Health); Lancet and Max Planck studies estimate more; the IDF claims over 17,000 militants killed without public evidence	Palestinian Information Center; Wikipedia
Israeli deaths	1,195 killed on 7 Oct 2023, about 815 of them civilians (HRW); 2,046+ killed in the war overall (Israeli sources)	Wikipedia
Refugees	About 5.9 million registered with UNRWA, about 2.4 million of them in Jordan	UNRWA; UNRWA Jordan
Recognition of Palestine	About 157 of 193 UN members (Sept 2025)	Wikipedia
Knesset (election of 27 Oct 2026)	Netanyahu bloc 53, Eisenkot-led bloc 48, Arab parties 19 (a record); no government as of 6 Nov	Times of Israel
Palestinian politics	Fatah 22%, Hamas 19%, "none" 33% (Oct 2026); legislative elections postponed to 11 Sept 2027	PCPSR

International law gives a common yardstick, though Israel rejects how it is applied. Resolution 242 (1967) stresses "the inadmissibility of the acquisition of territory by war" and every state's right to "secure and recognized boundaries" (UN). Resolution 2334 (2016) says settlements have "no legal validity" and that the Council "will not recognize any changes to the 4 June 1967 lines... other than those agreed by the parties" (UN). Article 49 of the Fourth Geneva Convention bans forcible transfers and deportations from occupied territory "regardless of their motive", and bars an occupying power

from moving its own civilians into the territory it occupies (ICRC). The Rome Statute lists deportation or forcible transfer as a crime against humanity, and an occupier's transfer of its own population as a war crime (ICC).

The ICJ's advisory opinion of 19 July 2024 found Israel's continued presence in the territory occupied in 1967 **unlawful (11–4)** and said it must end "as rapidly as possible". The Court ordered an end to new settlement activity and the **evacuation of settlers (14–1)**. It found that Israeli policies leave Area C Palestinians "little choice but to leave", in breach of Article 49(1), and it told states not to recognise or aid the situation (12–3) (ICJ). It also found a "near-complete separation" of settler and Palestinian communities in breach of Article 3 of the Convention on the Elimination of Racial Discrimination, which condemns "racial segregation and apartheid". It did not say which of the two it had found (ICJ, Judge Brant; Verfassungsblog). Netanyahu called the opinion "a decision of lies", saying "the Jewish people are not occupiers in their own land", and Israel formally rejected it (Wikipedia).

Enforcement has been weak. Advisory opinions and General Assembly resolutions are not binding in themselves, and the Assembly's 12-month deadline for withdrawal (resolution ES-10/24) passed in September 2025 with no compliance and no enforcement (Bernama). B'Tselem (2021), Human Rights Watch (2021) and Amnesty (2022) apply the legal label "apartheid", each to a different territorial scope; Israel and the US State Department reject their conclusions (HRW; Amnesty; Wikipedia). South Africa's genocide case is years from judgment, with written pleadings scheduled into 2029 (South African Presidency).

Public opinion has moved in opposite directions since 2023, and large undecided blocs mean it is not fixed. The last joint Palestinian–Israeli Pulse poll (PCPSR and Tel Aviv University, July 2024) found two-state support at **21% of Israeli Jews, 40% of Palestinians and 72% of Arab citizens of Israel**. A record **42% of Israeli Jews backed annexing the West Bank without equal rights**, and 33% of Palestinians backed a Palestinian state in which Jews lack full rights (Pulse). Pew's 2026 survey found that only **16% of Jewish Israelis and 21% of West Bank Palestinians** believe Israel and a Palestinian state can coexist peacefully (Pew). In September 2025 the Israel Democracy Institute found that almost three-quarters of Jewish Israelis say Palestinians have no right to a state of their own (IDI). Palestinian support rebounds when the question names the borders: PCPSR found **56% in August 2026 and 53% in October 2026** backing a state on the 1967 lines, even though 58% say settlements have made two states impractical (PCPSR Poll 97; PCPSR October 2026).

2025–2026 widened the gap between diplomacy and the ground. Abroad, the UK, France, Canada, Australia and others recognised Palestine in September 2025, and the General Assembly endorsed the Franco-Saudi New York Declaration 142–10–12 (Wikipedia; Times of Israel). At home, the Knesset voted 68–9 against a Palestinian state in July 2024 and 71–13 for a declaratory sovereignty motion in July 2025 (The JC; Jerusalem Post). In February 2026 the cabinet opened land purchases in the West Bank to Israelis, extended Israeli enforcement into Areas A and B, and restarted land registration in Area C for the first time since 1967. Smotrich called these steps "de facto sovereignty"; the UN human rights office called registration an exercise of sovereignty that is prohibited in occupied territory (Times of Israel; UN Palestine).

In Gaza, the October 2025 ceasefire under Trump's 20-point plan and UN Security Council Resolution 2803 created a Board of Peace and an International Stabilization Force. By November 2026, however, the Palestinian technocratic committee had not entered Gaza, and the order of disarmament and withdrawal was still disputed (Gaza Biweekly; INSS). Israel's 27 October election produced a hung Knesset. Gadi Eisenkot received 67 recommendations, including from the Arab parties, which Netanyahu refuses to govern with (Wikipedia; Al Jazeera). A Saudi source told KAN that normalisation

"is not on the agenda" while Netanyahu's government remains (Jerusalem Post), and Abbas postponed the 28 November 2026 legislative elections to 11 September 2027 (PCPSR). A war with Iran in 2026, whose 7 April ceasefire fell during Pew's fieldwork, diverted attention, and Indonesia paused its stabilisation-force commitment "amid the Iran crisis" (Pew; Wikipedia).

The report orders proposals in five families, from Israeli sovereignty over all the land to one state over all the land. The ordering follows who holds sovereignty over territory. A second axis cuts across it: whether the non-sovereign people get equal political rights. That second axis is why the "one state" label covers opposites (annexation without rights and one democratic state), and why the far poles mirror each other: each envisages one people's sovereignty over all the land with the other removed or disenfranchised (INSS; Pulse).

Family 1 — Israeli sovereignty over all the land: maximal territory meets the demographic wall

These proposals share Bezalel Smotrich's premise that there is "room for only one expression of national self-determination west of the Jordan River" (HaShiloach). They differ on what happens to the 5.5 million Palestinians of the West Bank and Gaza: removal, disenfranchisement or gradual citizenship. The demographic arithmetic in the baseline explains why annexation and "emigration" proposals so often come paired. Among these plans, transfer is the only mechanism that decisively changes the population ratio.

Transfer and "voluntary emigration" remain a far-right platform that no host state accepts

Origin and proponents. Transfer has a long pedigree and a revived present. The 1937 Peel Commission paired partition with a transfer of about 225,000 Arabs out of the proposed Jewish state (Wikipedia: Peel Commission). Historians still dispute how far Ben-Gurion endorsed compulsory transfer: Benny Morris cites a 1937 diary entry, while Efraim Karsh and Shabtai Teveth contest the reading (Wikipedia: 1937 Ben-Gurion letter). Meir Kahane's Kach was disqualified from the 1988 election under a 1985 anti-racism amendment and outlawed as a terrorist organisation in 1994 (JVL; Wikipedia: Kach). Rehavam Ze'evi's Moledet advocated "a more genteel, negotiated 'transfer'" (JTA).

After 7 October 2023 the idea moved closer to government. An Intelligence Ministry concept paper dated 13 October 2023 recommended moving Gaza's civilians into tent cities and then permanent cities in northern Sinai, and telling them there was "no hope of returning". Netanyahu's office described it as a non-binding paper (+972 Magazine; AP via NBC). Calls by Smotrich and Itamar Ben-Gvir for "voluntary emigration" and the resettlement of Gaza drew a rare named rebuke from the State Department in January 2024 (France 24). On 4 February 2025 Trump proposed a US "takeover" of Gaza as the "Riviera of the Middle East", with its population relocated (Axios). A related "GREAT Trust" prospectus offered each departing Gazan $5,000 plus rent and food subsidies (Al-Monitor/Reuters). On 23 March 2025 the security cabinet created a Defence Ministry "Directorate for Voluntary Transition of Gaza Residents" (JNS). For the 2026 election, Ben-Gvir proposed an emigration ministry targeting **250,000 departures in the first year and about 1.86 million within seven years**. He insisted that "we are not forcing anyone to leave, but there is encouragement for this" (Algemeiner).

Core terms. Israel keeps all the territory, and the population ratio changes through departure. Gaza is the main target. Proposed destinations are Sinai, Jordan and distant third states; Somaliland, South Sudan and DR Congo have been discussed (Algemeiner). Security stays Israeli and Jerusalem is not at

issue. Settlements expand, and Smotrich's and Ben-Gvir's versions add resettlement of Gaza. The refugee problem grows rather than shrinks, because departure is meant to be permanent, and those who leave lose any political stake. The variants differ mainly in how much consent they claim, from Kach's compulsion to the incentive schemes, and that is the contested legal variable.

Legal and ethical assessment. Forcible transfer is prohibited and can be criminal. Article 49(1) applies "regardless of their motive", and customary humanitarian law treats displacement as forced when people lack genuine choice (ICRC Rule 129). Deportation or forcible transfer is a crime against humanity under Article 7(1)(d) of the Rome Statute (ICC). In February 2025 the UN High Commissioner for Human Rights, Volker Türk, said "any forcible transfer in or deportation of people from occupied territory is strictly prohibited", and Secretary-General Guterres warned against "any form of ethnic cleansing" (The New Arab; KSL/AP). In November 2024 Human Rights Watch found that the displacement of more than 90% of Gazans amounted to war crimes and crimes against humanity, and in some areas to ethnic cleansing; NGO Monitor called the report one-sided (HRW; NGO Monitor). Israeli ministers say the emigration programme complies with international law because departures are voluntary (JNS). Critics answer that consent given amid destruction, famine and blockade is not free (Al Majalla). **This report flags transfer in any form not based on genuinely free individual choice as a breach of international law.**

Public support. Israeli Jewish support is high but sensitive to wording. A Penn State/Geocartography survey (March 2025; authors Tamir Sorek and Shay Hazkani) reported **82% support for expelling Gazans** and 56% for expelling Palestinian citizens of Israel. Sources disagree on whether the 82% refers to Jewish Israelis or all Israelis. Critics argue the forced-choice format inflated the figure: when an aChord poll offered a neutral option, 26% chose it (The New Arab; Haaretz via JFJFP). The Jewish People Policy Institute found that about eight in ten Jewish Israelis welcomed Trump's relocation idea in February 2025, but support for it as a "practical solution" fell from 43% to 32% a month later (JNS; JPPI). Among Gazans, PCPSR found in May 2025 that about 43% would be ready to emigrate after the war, a figure other write-ups break down differently (FDD; JNS).

Feasibility as of November 2026: negligible at scale. In the year to September 2026 about 10,500 people left Gaza: 3,015 patients, 5,220 companions and about 2,300 for study, family reunification or residency. About 6,000 returned, and no country agreed to take Gazans at scale (Algemeiner). Egypt's president called displacement an injustice "in which we cannot participate". Jordan rejected any "alternative homeland", and the Arab League adopted a $53 billion reconstruction plan that keeps Gazans in place (Egyptian Streets; Ahram Online; Irish Times). By March 2025 Trump was saying "nobody's expelling any Palestinians". His September 2025 plan states that no one will be forced to leave Gaza and that those who leave may return (Arab News; Arab News). In November 2025 a charter flight carried 153 Gazans to Johannesburg; Haaretz reported it was coordinated with the Defence Ministry's emigration bureau, and South Africa's foreign minister called it part of a plan to "clear" Gaza (AP via ADN; AP). In the October 2026 election Otzma Yehudit and Religious Zionism won 13 of 120 seats, inside a bloc short of a majority (Times of Israel). The government itself is split. Defence Minister Katz says there is "no real solution for Gaza in the end without this migration", while Foreign Minister Sa'ar says Israel is "not planning to expel or to deport anyone" (Algemeiner).

Critiques. Beyond the legal objections, Carnegie's Zaha Hassan argues that development schemes linked to the Board of Peace could converge with the emigration aim by leaving Gazans to choose between temporary compounds and resettlement abroad (Carnegie).

Annexation without equal rights draws 42% of Israeli Jews but meets a US veto

Origin and proponents. The most developed blueprint is Smotrich's **"Decisive Plan" (2017)**, adopted unanimously at a religious-Zionist conference that September (HaShiloach; Jewish Press). It calls for "full Israeli sovereignty" over Judea and Samaria and for "hundreds of thousands of additional settlers". It then gives Palestinians three options. Those who "forgo their national aspirations" may stay as individuals under six regional municipal administrations "lacking national characteristics" (Hebron, Bethlehem, Ramallah, Jericho, Nablus and Jenin). They would vote locally but not for the Knesset "at the first stage", and perhaps for Jordan's parliament instead, with citizenship "possible to consider" later on condition of loyalty and military or national service. Those who keep national ambitions would receive emigration grants. Those who fight would be dealt with by the security forces "with a strong hand" (HaShiloach).

The Sovereignty Movement of Yehudit Katsover and Nadia Matar seeks sovereignty over all of Judea and Samaria "without compromises or withdrawals". In a movement-aligned interview, Matar rejected citizenship and endorsed large-scale emigration (Israel National News; Oz Sheri interview). Former US ambassador David Friedman's 2024 plan proposes Israeli sovereignty over all of Judea and Samaria under an Israel–US–Abraham Accords agreement, with Palestinians as permanent residents holding travel documents but no Knesset vote (JNS). The settler leader Dani Dayan earlier proposed expanding personal freedoms without political rights (+972). Across these texts Jerusalem stays undivided under Israel, there is no refugee return, Gaza is usually left out, and security is wholly Israeli.

Legal and ethical assessment. Annexing occupied territory breaches the UN Charter's ban on the use of force and the rule against acquiring territory by force, as the ICJ applied it in 2024, and states are obliged not to recognise it (ICJ; UN Charter). Expanding settlements conflicts with Article 49(6). Denying national voting rights to an annexed population along national-ethnic lines is what B'Tselem, Yesh Din and HRW describe as apartheid. Yesh Din's 2020 legal opinion warned that formal annexation would merge the legal regimes and strengthen the case that Israel as a whole is an apartheid state (Yesh Din). Israeli officials reject the apartheid label (NGO Monitor). Critics call the Decisive Plan a blueprint for apartheid or a "second Nakba" (Mondoweiss), while +972 argues it still "defines the horizon of Israeli politics" (+972). **This report flags formal annexation, and the disenfranchisement of an annexed population, as breaches of international law.**

Public support. Among Israeli Jews, support is the largest of any option: **42% in July 2024**, double the two-state figure (Pulse). In December 2022, 37% backed "one non-democratic state ruled by Israel without equality for Palestinians", and 71% said Palestinians should not demand the vote after annexation (PCPSR/TAU). INSS polling in December 2024 split Israeli Jews three ways: 24% would annex the whole West Bank, 26% only the settlements, and 29% oppose any annexation (JVL). A June 2026 Direct Polls survey, commissioned by the Sovereignty Movement (an advocacy group), reported 59% backing some form of sovereignty (Israel365). On the other side, 78% of Palestinians said in 2022 that they would not take part in Knesset elections even if offered the vote (PCPSR/TAU).

Feasibility as of November 2026: formal annexation is blocked; de facto annexation is advancing. The 2020 attempt was suspended in exchange for normalisation with the UAE (Axios). In late 2025 Trump said Israel "would lose all of its support from the United States" if it annexed. Vice-President Vance called the 25–24 preliminary Knesset vote of October 2025 a "very stupid" political stunt, and the UAE called annexation a "red line" for the Abraham Accords (KSL/AP; Al Jazeera; Jewish News). The executive track moved ahead anyway. The February 2026 decisions on land registration and

enforcement were followed in August by the transfer of civilian enforcement in the West Bank from the army to the Israel Police, which critics call a "spearhead of annexation" (Times of Israel; Al Jazeera). The October 2026 election left the annexationist parties inside a 53-seat minority bloc.

Annexation with phased citizenship is the right's minority bet on a Jewish majority

Origin and proponents. A minority strand of the Israeli right, prominent between 2008 and 2014, argues that democracy and Greater Israel can coexist. Uri Elitzur, a former Yesha Council head, called in 2008 for annexation with a gradual path to citizenship. Likud MK Tzipi Hotovely called for granting citizenship "in gradual fashion". Knesset Speaker Reuven Rivlin said in 2010: "I would rather see Palestinians as citizens of this State than partition the land" (+972; +972). Moshe Arens and Uri Ariel backed versions that exclude Gaza. Caroline Glick's *The Israeli Solution* (2014) proposed sovereignty over all of Judea and Samaria, with permanent residency first and citizenship later (Wikipedia; Jewish News).

Core terms. Proponents interviewed by +972 described a unilateral annexation over 5–25 years, starting with Area C, then Area B, then Area A. Palestinians would receive blue Israeli identity cards with full rights after security vetting, and a Basic Law entrenching the Jewish state would be enacted first. There would be no refugee return, Gaza would be excluded and settlements would stay (+972).

Legal and ethical assessment. The model rests on a **contested demographic premise**. It relied on Yoram Ettinger's estimate of 1.5 million West Bank Palestinians excluding East Jerusalem, against PCBS's 3.43 million including it (+972; PCBS). Critics cite Sergio DellaPergola's projections against Glick (Jewish News). The model removes the disenfranchisement problem but not the annexation problem. Without an agreement it still conflicts with the non-acquisition rule, and it offers individual rights without Palestinian national self-determination.

Critiques. Within the right, Dayan and Danny Danon opposed Elitzur. Arens worried that Israel's treatment of its Arab citizens would prevent fair absorption, and a *Jerusalem Report* writer called the plan "delusional" (+972; Jerusalem Report).

Public support. No poll measures the citizenship variant directly. The right's base prefers the variant without rights, and only 14% of Israeli Jews back one state with equal rights (Pulse).

Feasibility as of November 2026: very low. Glick was still urging Israel to "annex everything" in August 2026 (Jewish Link), but the constituency is thin. The model is also unstable as an endpoint. With a Palestinian electorate of about 40% even without Gaza, it would likely drift either toward binational demands or back toward rights restrictions (INSS).

Family 2 — Israeli control with limited Palestinian self-rule: autonomy over people, not land

Proposals in this family give Palestinians self-administration over people while Israel keeps security control and, in most versions, the land. The line runs from Begin's 1977 autonomy plan through Smotrich's enclaves to the 2026 extension of Israeli enforcement into Areas A and B.

Autonomy plans from Allon to Camp David offered self-government with sovereignty left open

Origin and core terms. The **Allon Plan (1967)** would have annexed most of the Jordan Valley, East Jerusalem and the Etzion bloc, placing settlements so as to include "as few Arabs as possible". The populated hill country would have gone back to Jordan. The plan was never formally adopted but shaped Labor-era settlement (Wikipedia: Allon Plan).

Menachem Begin's 26-point autonomy plan (December 1977) would have abolished the military administration and created an elected 11-member Administrative Council, seated in Bethlehem, to run civil affairs, while "security and public order" stayed with Israel. Residents would have "the free option to receive either Israeli or Jordanian citizenship", and "Israeli residents will be entitled to purchase land and settle". Refugees would enter "in a reasonable volume", as decided by an Israel–Jordan–Council committee. Sovereignty would be left "open", for review after five years (JVL).

The **1978 Camp David Framework** recast autonomy as a five-year transition toward final-status talks (Cairo Review). Palestinians were not parties to it and refused to join. The 1979–82 talks foundered on self-government, settlements and East Jerusalem (US Office of the Historian).

Critiques. Israel's Village Leagues of the late 1970s and early 1980s grew from Menahem Milson's case for a rural leadership outside the PLO, and Palestinians still invoke them as the template for collaborationist local rule (Commentary; Wikipedia). The historian Seth Anziska describes the autonomy design as "state prevention" (Anziska, unofficial mirror).

Legal assessment. It depends on what autonomy is a step toward. As an interim stage toward an agreed final status, it resembles Oslo. As a permanent arrangement combined with Israeli land claims and continued settlement, it collides with the ICJ's 2024 findings on annexation and Article 49(6) (ICJ).

Public support. No current poll measures autonomy as an endgame.

Enclave and emirate models break Palestinian self-rule into city-islands

Three newer proposals turn autonomy into a territorial formula. Under **Naftali Bennett's "Israel Stability Initiative" (2012)**, Israel would annex Area C, about 60% of the West Bank and all its settlements, and offer full citizenship to the Palestinians living there. PA autonomy would expand in Areas A and B, and Gaza would be left out. The population count is contested: Bennett estimated about 50,000 Palestinians in Area C, while OCHA put the figure at 150,000 (Palestine Studies; Algemeiner). Bennett's list won 12 seats in October 2026, but no 2026 source shows him still advocating the plan (Jerusalem Post).

Smotrich's map of 3 September 2025 would annex **82% of the West Bank** and leave six Palestinian population centres as enclaves, on the principle of "maximum land, minimum population" (Times of Israel). **Mordechai Kedar's "Palestinian Emirates" plan** (from 2012) proposes eight clan-based city-states on the Gulf model: Gaza, Jenin, Nablus, Ramallah, Jericho, Tulkarm, Qalqilya and Arab Hebron. Israel would keep the rural land and overall security between the non-contiguous enclaves. The plan bypasses Jerusalem, refugees and borders (Wikipedia; FPA).

The emirate idea's one field test came in July 2025, when the *Wall Street Journal* reported a letter from five Hebron sheikhs led by Wadee' al-Jaabari. They proposed an "Emirate of Hebron" that would recognise Israel as the Jewish state and join the Abraham Accords. Economy Minister Nir Barkat, who had met them repeatedly, asked: "Who in Israel is going to say no?" (Ynet; JNS). Hebron's families issued a joint statement backing the PLO, the Ja'abari family disowned its relative, and the PA called it an

"Israeli plan". Hamas denounced it as normalisation, and al-Jaabari's car was reportedly torched (Ahram Online; Middle East Eye; JNS). Barkat publicly endorsed the emirates framework, but the *Times of Israel* noted that no Emirate of Hebron exists in practice (Israel National News; CIJR citing ToI).

Legal and ethical assessment. Annexing Area C or 82% of the West Bank is annexation of occupied territory and breaches the same rules as full annexation. The ICJ has already identified Israeli policies in Area C and East Jerusalem as amounting to annexation (ICJ).

Critiques. Critics compare the enclaves to South Africa's Bantustans and warn of clan violence (Wikipedia). A Palestinian think-tank calls the emirates idea an "orientalist" blueprint for dismantling the national cause (Vision PD).

Public support. No poll measures these models.

Feasibility as of November 2026: low as a declared endgame. No Abraham Accords state endorsed the Hebron proposal. Still, the February 2026 extension of Israeli enforcement into Areas A and B moves the de facto map toward this family (Times of Israel).

The Jordanian option died in 1988, and Amman treats any revival as a threat

Origin and proponents. Two distinct ideas share the label. Labor's **Jordanian option** (1967–1988) sought territorial compromise with Hashemite Jordan instead of a Palestinian state. It peaked with the **Peres–Hussein London Agreement of 11 April 1987** on a UN-hosted conference. Prime Minister Shamir rejected that agreement, which effectively ended the option (ECF; Brookings). King Hussein's **disengagement of 31 July 1988** cut legal and administrative ties with the West Bank, though Jordan kept its custodianship of Jerusalem's Muslim holy sites (UNISPAL).

"Jordan is Palestine" was revived by Likud figures, Sharon and Shamir among them, from the late 1970s. It cast Jordan as the Palestinian state, and in some formulations implied mass transfer (MERIP; Oxford). Traces survive on the right: Smotrich's plan lets Palestinians eventually vote for Jordan's parliament, and Hotovely has argued that Jordan was meant to be the Arab state (HaShiloach; Wikipedia).

Core terms. In the Allon-style form, Israel gets the Jordan Valley, East Jerusalem and the settlement blocs. The populated areas and their residents go to Jordan as Jordanian citizens, refugees are absorbed east of the river, and Jordan keeps a role at the holy sites.

Legal assessment. A Jordanian option imposed without Palestinian consent sits badly with the Palestinian right to self-determination that the ICJ affirmed (ICJ). Any "Jordan is Palestine" variant that involves transfer would breach Article 49(1).

Feasibility as of November 2026: negligible, because Jordan holds a hard veto. King Abdullah calls the "substitute homeland" idea an "illusion" and says "Jordan is Jordan and Palestine is Palestine". Foreign Minister Safadi said in January 2025 that all talk of an alternative homeland "is rejected" (Royal Hashemite Court; Ahram Online).

Conflict management, "shrinking" and economic peace put off the end state indefinitely

Origin and proponents. Conflict management treats the end state as deferred without limit. Efraim Inbar and Eitan Shamir of Bar-Ilan University coined **"mowing the grass"** in the *Journal of Strategic Studies* (2013–14). The phrase describes periodic short operations that degrade Hamas and buy "a period of quiet" without a political settlement. The authors warned that the approach could become outdated if non-state actors grew stronger (Wikipedia).

Under Netanyahu the strategy was paired with Qatari cash for Hamas-run Gaza. A *New York Times* investigation reported about $15 million a month by 2018 and about $30 million a month by 2021. In former intelligence official Yossi Kuperwasser's words, the logic was that Hamas should be "strong enough to rule Gaza" but "weak enough to be deterred" (Irish Times/NYT). A widely quoted 2019 remark attributed to Netanyahu, that thwarting a Palestinian state requires "bolstering Hamas", rests on press reports rather than a recording. Netanyahu calls the claim that he built up Hamas "ridiculous" (Times of Israel; Ynet). The Shin Bet's probe into 7 October named the policy of "calm" and the Qatari funds among the factors that let Hamas build up (Times of Israel). A 2026 *TIME* investigation, as summarised by Ynet, reports that nearly $2 billion was moved with Israeli facilitation (Ynet).

Three softer variants share the premise. **"Shrinking the conflict"**, from Micah Goodman's *Catch-67* (2017), proposed reducing friction through permits, roads, trade and more self-rule, without withdrawal or a state. The 2021 Bennett–Lapid government adopted it as coalition glue; in Goodman's words, "There is no consensus in the government about the end game, but they can agree about the game". That government issued 15,000 new work permits while tentatively approving about 2,000 settlement units (CNN via KTVZ; +972).

Economic peace, which Netanyahu described in 2009 as "not a substitute for political peace" (Al Jazeera), became the June 2019 Bahrain workshop's $50 billion, one-million-job prospectus, which left out borders, Jerusalem and refugees. The PA boycotted the workshop, and the related Abraham Fund never received money (Al Jazeera; Wikipedia). **Normalisation without a Palestinian component** is the third: the 2020 Abraham Accords with the UAE, Bahrain, Morocco and Sudan, joined by Kazakhstan in 2025, reversed the Arab Peace Initiative's sequence (Wikipedia).

Core terms. The terms are the status quo: no change in sovereignty, full IDF security control, continued settlement, Jerusalem and refugees unaddressed, and Palestinian political rights limited to the PA.

Legal assessment. Indefinite management conflicts with the ICJ's 2024 finding that the occupation itself is unlawful and must end "as rapidly as possible" (ICJ).

Critiques. On the right, a former Netanyahu aide called the 2021 period "just a lull between wars". On the left, Dahlia Scheindlin warned that it perpetuates "the paradigm of Israel giveth and Israel taketh away" (CNN via KTVZ). +972 calls it "managing the occupation" (+972).

Public support. No poll measures conflict management as such. Its implicit constituency is the bloc that rejects every option or is undecided: 34% of Israeli Jews and 44% of Palestinians in 2024 (PSR policy brief).

Feasibility as of November 2026. As a long-term solution it lost credibility on 7 October 2023. As a default it remains the most likely state of the world, now in a harder form. J Street concluded in mid-2026 that "Hamas and Israel both seem to prefer the status quo" in Gaza (J Street).

Regional normalisation has turned from a substitute into a lever. INSS describes Riyadh's demand for a state on the 1967 lines with East Jerusalem as "unequivocal and non-negotiable", and a Saudi source in May 2026 set the bar as an "irreversible pathway" to statehood. In August 2025, 99% of Saudi respondents called normal relations with Israel a negative step (INSS; Times of Israel).

Family 3 — Partition: aligned with the legal consensus, least popular in Israel

Partition proposals give Palestinians sovereignty over part of the land, or, in the three-state variant, hand that part to Arab neighbours. They range from a conditional state on about 70% of the West Bank to the 1967 lines with minor one-for-one swaps.

Three-state options would hand Palestinian sovereignty to Egypt and Jordan, which refuse it

Origin and proponents. The **Egyptian–Jordanian "three-state" option** would restore the 1949–67 pattern: Gaza would go to Egypt, and the parts of the West Bank not annexed by Israel would go to Jordan. John Bolton called it the "most attractive prospect" in January 2009, and revived it after 7 October, declaring two states "dead" (Washington Post; Jordan News). Binyamin Elon, Aryeh Eldad, Daniel Pipes and Ian Bremmer backed versions of it (Wikipedia). Giora Eiland's regional swap would enlarge Gaza with about 600 km^2 of northern Sinai in exchange for Negev land for Egypt; reported figures vary (Daily Alert summary of Haaretz).

Core terms. Security, refugees and citizenship pass to Cairo and Amman. Israel keeps the annexed West Bank and its settlements, and Jerusalem stays Israeli.

Legal assessment. The option forecloses Palestinian statehood, which sits badly with Palestinian self-determination.

Critiques. *Foreign Policy* called it "Bolton's zombie idea" (Foreign Policy).

Public support. No poll measures it.

Feasibility as of November 2026: negligible. Egypt and Jordan have refused it for decades. On 18 October 2023 President Sisi rejected "the liquidation of the Palestinian cause and any relocation to Sinai" (Dawn). In February 2025 Egypt called Yair Lapid's idea of a 15-year Egyptian administration of Gaza "unacceptable", and Cairo says it "will not govern Gaza" (Arab News; Daily News Egypt).

A second meaning of "three states" describes the **de facto split since 2007**: Israel, a PA-run West Bank and Hamas-run Gaza. Resolution 2803 has now institutionalised it with a separate technocratic committee for Gaza (Wikipedia). This is a drift state, not a design.

The 2020 Trump plan stretched "statehood" to a conditional minimum

Origin. Trump's "Peace to Prosperity" vision was unveiled on 28 January 2020 without Palestinian participation. It is formally a two-state plan, placed at the far Israeli edge of the family (Wikipedia).

Core terms. On borders and settlements, the plan text incorporates about 97% of West Bank Israelis into Israel and 97% of West Bank Palestinians into Palestine. It puts the Jordan Valley "under Israeli sovereignty", says Israel "will not have to uproot any settlements", and compensates Palestine with Negev areas near Gaza (White House PDF); press estimates put the Palestinian share at about 70% of the West Bank (Fortune). Jerusalem "will remain the sovereign capital of the State of Israel" and stay "undivided", with a Palestinian capital beyond the separation barrier in Kafr Aqab, eastern Shuafat and Abu Dis. The holy-site status quo "should continue", yet the text also says "people of every faith should be permitted to pray" on the Temple Mount/Haram al-Sharif. There is "no right of return… into the State of Israel": refugees could settle in Palestine, stay in host countries, or move to member states of the Organisation of Islamic Cooperation at 5,000 a year for ten years. Israel keeps "overriding security

responsibility" over a "fully demilitarized" Palestine, and Israel and the US would jointly judge whether the conditions for statehood had been met. The plan also "contemplates the possibility" of transferring ten Arab "Triangle" towns inside Israel to Palestine (White House PDF).

Legal and ethical assessment. The plan's annexation of about 30% of the West Bank conflicts with the non-acquisition rule. On the Triangle clause, the legal scholar Yuval Shany objected that a state "cannot strip its own nationals of their citizenships against their will" (NYRB). Fifty former European leaders said the plan would create an apartheid-like situation (Wikipedia).

Critiques and support. Abbas called it the "slap of the century". The Arab League and the Organisation of Islamic Cooperation rejected it, and the settler Yesha Council opposed it because it envisaged a Palestinian state (Wikipedia). **94% of Palestinians opposed it** in February 2020 (Times of Israel).

Feasibility. The plan was shelved when Israel suspended annexation in exchange for UAE normalisation in August 2020 (Axios). Its conditional, undated "pathway" to statehood resurfaces in the 2025 Gaza plan and Resolution 2803 (Wikipedia).

The negotiated band from Clinton to Kerry spans 2–7% swaps and a holy-sites deal-breaker

Origins. Partition dates to the **Peel Commission (1937)**, which judged that "an irrepressible conflict has arisen between two national communities within the narrow bounds of one small country" (Wikipedia: Peel Commission). It continued with **UN General Assembly Resolution 181 (1947)**, which allotted 56.47% of Mandate Palestine to a Jewish state, 42.88% to an Arab state and 0.65% to an international Jerusalem–Bethlehem zone. The Jewish Agency accepted the plan, Arab leaders rejected it, and the 1948 war followed (Wikipedia: UN Partition Plan). After 1967 the "land for peace" formula of Resolution 242 became the frame. In 1988 the PLO accepted 242 as the basis for negotiations, a step known as the "historic compromise" (Wikipedia: Palestinian Declaration of Independence; Wikipedia: Resolution 242). The Oslo Accords (1993–95) created the PA and the patchwork of Areas A, B and C, deferring every core issue to permanent-status talks that never concluded (Wikipedia: Oslo II).

The negotiated packages. Permanent-status talks produced a narrow band of package deals. At **Camp David (July 2000)** Israel reportedly offered a state on about 73% of the West Bank, rising to about 92%, with Israeli sovereignty over the Temple Mount and Palestinian "custodianship". The summit broke down mainly over sovereignty at the holy sites. Blame is still disputed: Clinton and Dennis Ross blamed Arafat, while Robert Malley and Hussein Agha argued the offer did not meet core Palestinian needs (Wikipedia: Camp David; Malley and Agha, NYRB).

The **Clinton Parameters (December 2000)** set the template. They proposed a state on 94–96% of the West Bank plus Gaza, with settlement blocs holding about 80% of settlers annexed against swaps of 1–3%. Arab neighbourhoods of Jerusalem would go to Palestine and Jewish ones to Israel, with Palestinian sovereignty over the Haram and Israeli sovereignty over the Western Wall. Palestine would be a non-militarised state with an international force, and the IDF would withdraw over 36 months plus a further 36 at fixed Jordan Valley sites. Refugees could return to Palestine, stay in host states or move to third states, and enter Israel only with Israel's agreement. The package ended all claims, and both sides accepted it "with reservations" (Wikipedia). At **Taba (January 2001)** Israel lowered its demand to about 6% annexed with 3% compensation, and the Palestinians proposed about 3% at one-for-one. The joint statement said the sides "have never been closer", before Sharon's election ended the talks (Wikipedia). The unofficial **Geneva Initiative (2003)** filled in the template as a model treaty: under 3% annexed at one-for-one, leaving Ariel and Efrat outside Israel; Palestinian sovereignty over the

Haram with a multinational presence; a refugee option to Israel capped by the average intake of third countries; and two Israeli early-warning stations for 15 years alongside a multinational force (Geneva Accord; Palestine-Israel Journal).

Ehud Olmert's 2008 offer was the furthest-reaching on record. Israeli accounts have it annexing 6.3% of the West Bank in exchange for 5.8% plus a safe passage; the Palestinian summary in the Palestine Papers gives 6.8% for 5.5%. The Holy Basin would have come under no state's sovereignty, run by a five-nation body. Israel would have admitted 1,000 refugees a year for five years, and the Palestinian state would have had no army or air force. Abbas says he was not allowed to keep the map to study it, and the process ended with Olmert's departure (INSS-hosted summary; JVL; JTA). The **Kerry talks (2013–14)** drafted "1967 lines with mutual agreed swaps" alongside recognition of Israel as "the nation-state of the Jewish people". They collapsed over a withheld prisoner release, settlement announcements, the PA's accession to 15 international conventions and a Fatah–Hamas unity deal. Kerry restated the package as six principles in December 2016 (New Republic; Wikipedia).

Legal and ethical assessment. This family aligns most closely with the legal anchors. Resolution 2334 allows changes to the 1967 lines "agreed by the parties", so annexing settlement blocs by agreement fits. Evacuating the remaining settlements matches the ICJ's 2024 order (UN; ICJ).

The contested point is refugees. Resolution 194 says refugees "wishing to return… should be permitted to do so". Israel reads that as non-binding and conditional (Wikipedia: Resolution 194). Caps of 5,000–100,000 meet Israel's demographic concern, but those who treat return as an individual right reject them. Hamas's 2017 document calls return non-negotiable, and Amnesty describes its denial as part of a system of apartheid (Middle East Eye; Amnesty). Geneva's own critics warned that its limits on sovereignty risked "almost turning the Palestinian state into an international protectorate" (Palestine-Israel Journal).

The Arab Peace Initiative and the "outside-in" track add regional and multilateral payoffs

The **Arab Peace Initiative (Beirut, 2002)** attaches a regional reward. It offers full Arab normalisation in exchange for withdrawal to the 4 June 1967 lines including the Golan, a state with East Jerusalem as its capital, and an "agreed" just solution under Resolution 194. In 2013 the Arab League accepted "comparable and mutually agreed minor swaps" (JVL text; Wikipedia). Israeli responses ranged from Sharon's "non-starter" to Olmert's "revolutionary change". Netanyahu called the "general idea" good in 2015 but rejected it as a basis for talks in 2018 (Wikipedia; Times of Israel).

Since 2024 a third, **"outside-in" track** has reversed the negotiating sequence: recognise the state first, then build it through a multilateral mechanism. The New York Declaration of July–September 2025 sets a 15-month path to a demilitarised, sovereign Palestine governing all its territory, with a temporary UN-mandated stabilisation mission. Hamas must end its rule in Gaza and hand its weapons to the PA (Wikipedia; Al Arabiya). In a June 2025 letter to Macron and Mohammed bin Salman, Abbas said the state "has no intention to be a militarized State" and promised elections within a year (Arab News).

The US called the conference "unproductive and ill-timed" (State Department). Germany, Italy, Japan and the US still withhold recognition, and Slovenia's new government announced plans to withdraw its 2024 recognition (Wikipedia). At the one-year follow-up in September 2026, Guterres said the conditions for a viable state were being "systematically erased" and that E1 would "deal a deathblow" to contiguity (UN News).

Two-state support is lowest exactly where implementation depends on it

Public support. In July 2024 the Pulse tested a detailed package: a demilitarised state, the Green Line with equal swaps, family reunification of 100,000 refugees in Israel, a divided Jerusalem with the Western Wall Israeli and the Haram Palestinian, regional peace, and an end of claims. It drew **34% of Palestinians, 25% of Israeli Jews and 69% of Arab Israelis**, down from peaks of 43% and 45% in 2017–18 (Pulse). In mid-2025 Gallup found 27% of Israelis and 33% of West Bank and East Jerusalem Palestinians supporting a Palestinian state alongside Israel (Gallup). Among Israeli Jews, support is 6% on the right, 1–3% among Haredi and national-religious voters, and **8% among those aged 18–35** (Pulse). Among Palestinians, an April 2026 West Bank poll found 65.6% would accept a negotiated 1967 state, but only 20.5% thought Israelis would accept one (Palestinian Peace Coalition).

Feasibility as of November 2026: low in the near term. The Israeli government rejects the outcome. Netanyahu declared "There will be no Palestinian state" at an E1 event in September 2025 (Dawn), and E1 received final approval for 3,401 housing units that August (Peace Now). At Clinton's ratio of 80% of settlers in annexed blocs, today's 541,000 West Bank settlers would leave about 100,000–110,000 outside the blocs, against about 40,000 in 2000; this is a calculation from CBS and registry figures, not a sourced estimate. On the Palestinian side, Hamas's disarmament is unresolved, and 74% of Palestinians oppose disarming before a full Israeli withdrawal (PCPSR). The swing factors are external and electoral. Saudi normalisation is tied to a credible pathway and to Netanyahu's exit, and Eisenkot's bloc holds 48 seats without the Arab parties (Jerusalem Post; Times of Israel).

Critiques. They come from three directions. On security, 52% of Israeli Jews expect an accord to increase violence (Pulse). One-state advocates such as Tony Judt, Virginia Tilley and Ian Lustick argue that settlements have already foreclosed partition (NYRB; Wikipedia: Paradigm Lost). Palestinian critics object to trading refugee return for statehood (Wikipedia). The failure modes that recurred between 2000 and 2014 are all still present: leaders running out of time, disputes over sequencing, settlement and prisoner deals, violent spoilers, and sovereignty over the holy sites.

Family 4 — Shared and layered sovereignty: residency separated from citizenship

Confederation keeps two states but lets settlers and refugees live across the line

Origin and proponents. Confederation keeps two sovereign states, roughly on the 1967 lines, but separates citizenship from residence. **A Land for All** ("Two States, One Homeland") was founded in 2012 by the Israeli journalist Meron Rapoport and the Palestinian activist Awni al-Mashni. Standing Together, a mass Jewish–Arab movement, adopted its framework in November 2025 and launched a party, **Makom Lekulanu**, in June 2026 (Forward; Forward). The scholarly version comes from Dahlia Scheindlin and Dov Waxman's "two-state solution 2.0" (2016), and from Omar Dajani and Limor Yehuda's *Foreign Affairs* essay (2024), which calls confederation "at its core, a two-state solution" (Guardian via inkl; Foreign Affairs).

A Land for All's core terms. The movement proposes two democratic states on the Green Line in an open-border confederation on the EU model. Citizens of either state may live anywhere as permanent residents while voting in their own state, so settlers may stay in Palestine as Israeli citizens under Palestinian law. Palestine may grant refugees return to its territory, with a gradual option to live in Israel. Jerusalem is "an open and shared city" and the capital of both. Shared bodies handle water,

health and finance, alongside a joint assembly and a human rights court. Each state has full security responsibility inside its own territory, with no Israeli military presence in Palestine (Wikipedia; MyJewishLearning; American Prospect).

The Holy Land Confederation's core terms. The most detailed text is the plan by Yossi Beilin and Hiba Husseini (second edition, July 2025), which swaps **2.5%** of the land. Israel annexes 21 West Bank settlements (247,044 Israelis) and eight East Jerusalem neighbourhoods (200,979), while **105 settlements with 193,565 Israelis stay under Palestinian sovereignty**; their residents become permanent residents of Palestine and keep Israeli citizenship. In return, an equal number of Palestinians may settle in Israel as permanent residents, and residents on both sides have equal rights "in every possible respect, except for participation in national elections". Refugees choose among Palestine, the swapped areas, host or third countries, or a limited option in Israel "commensurate with the average number of refugees absorbed by other countries". Jerusalem has two capitals and two municipalities, and the Old City (about 1 km^2) becomes a "confederal and open entity" with joint police. The confederation has no army of its own. Israel leads external defence at first, international forces deploy in Palestine with limited Israeli participation, the Israeli Air Force provides air defence for the whole area, and a joint counter-terror force may operate in Palestine for 3–5 years. A modified shekel serves both states (ECF). NPR/AP coverage in 2023 described the plan as having no land swaps, which its text contradicts (KUNC/NPR).

Legal assessment. Confederation stays inside the 1967-lines-with-agreed-changes framework. Letting settlers remain under Palestinian sovereignty by agreement departs from the ICJ's call to evacuate them, though it does so with consent (ICJ).

Critiques. Shira Efron and Evan Gottesman list five problems. The partners are asymmetric, one strong and one never sovereign. Palestinians fear settlers staying, and Israel is reluctant to share control of borders. Residents who are not citizens would have unequal status. And the scheme pairs a democracy with a non-democratic system. They also cite a RAND finding of "relatively low rates of acceptance" (+972). Lawfare warned that building a confederation could be harder than a two-state deal (Lawfare). The One Democratic State Campaign dismisses confederation and two states alike as "simply variations of the two-state solution" (ODSC).

Public support. It is a minority position. In July 2024 confederation drew **12% of Israeli Jews, 20% of all Israelis, 52% of Arab Israelis and 35% of Palestinians**. As a Palestinian forced first choice it drew 18% in October 2025 and 14% in August 2026 (Pulse; PCPSR Poll 96; PCPSR Poll 97).

Feasibility as of November 2026: low. Confederation needs every condition of a two-state deal plus enough trust to open the borders. It is, however, the only hybrid with a new party behind it in Israel.

A Jordanian–Palestinian confederation is acceptable to Amman only after statehood

Origin. Union ideas run from King Hussein's 1972 "United Arab Kingdom" plan to the **Hussein–Arafat Amman Accord of 11 February 1985**, which called for self-determination "within the framework of a Palestinian state and a Jordanian-Palestinian confederation". Hussein suspended the accord in 1986, and the PLO abrogated it in 1987 (Wikipedia; JVL; Harvard Crimson). In 2018 Abbas said Jared Kushner and Jason Greenblatt had floated a confederation with Jordan, and that he would accept only if Israel joined too. Jordan said it was "not on the table" (JTA; Jordan Times).

Positions. Jordan will consider confederation **only after** an independent Palestinian state exists, out of fear that the kingdom could be "transformed into a Palestinian state" (Arab News). Giora Eiland and Benny Morris have proposed Jordanian-led versions as substitutes for statehood (The JC; Wikipedia).

Public support. In 2018, 29% of Palestinians backed confederation with Jordan, and 75% opposed one that included Israel (PSR).

Feasibility as of November 2026. As an option after statehood it is plausible but distant. As a substitute for statehood, Jordan's veto makes it negligible.

Federation and "parallel states" divide into Israeli-led and genuinely shared designs

Federal designs come in opposite forms. The **UNSCOP minority plan (1947)** of India, Iran and Yugoslavia proposed an independent federal state with Arab and Jewish regions and Jerusalem as the federal capital (IsraelEd). Palestinian intellectuals have proposed a **Belgian-style binational federation** of language communities and autonomous regions; Harvard's Robert Mnookin notes that the combined territory is roughly Belgium's size (Harvard PON). Bosnia's Dayton settlement is invoked mainly as a warning; one analysis argues the analogy breaks down because one side is a sovereign occupier (Palestine-Israel Journal).

The Israeli **Federation Movement** proposes 30 Swiss-style cantons, 20 Jewish-majority and 10 Arab-majority, under a federal constitution. West Bank Arabs would receive Israeli citizenship, settlements would remain, the IDF would be the only army, and Gaza would stay outside as a separate state. No Israeli party has endorsed it. The right fears a Palestinian influx, and the left suspects it legitimises settlements (Ynet; Intermountain Jewish News). Mark LeVine and Mathias Mossberg's **"parallel states"** (2014) would divide sovereignty without dividing the land: two states would overlap across the whole territory, each governing its own nationals, with some functions joint and others separate. The authors argue this "may in fact be the only way to preserve a two-state solution" (UCI News; Tablet).

Legal assessment. A federation with equal citizenship and the consent of both peoples fits equality norms. The Israeli-led cantonal version keeps the settlements and a single army.

Public support. No poll measures federation.

Feasibility as of November 2026: very low. No party or polling base supports any federal model.

Trusteeship ranges from the 1947 corpus separatum to the Board of Peace in Gaza

International administration has three layers. The first is the 1947 **corpus separatum**: Resolution 181 made Jerusalem a separate international entity under the UN Trusteeship Council, with a Governor from neither community, demilitarisation, a special police force and a referendum after ten years (Avalon). Neither party has accepted it since 1948. The second is a set of **Holy Basin regimes** that carve the Old City out of a two-state deal. Olmert's 2008 plan proposed a five-state, non-sovereign trusteeship of Saudi Arabia, Jordan, Palestine, Israel and the US, and the 2024 Olmert–al-Kidwa plan revived it. The Jerusalem Old City Initiative proposes a "special regime" headed by a Chief Administrator who is neither Israeli nor Palestinian (Middle East Forum; Al Majalla; JOCI). The third, and the only live experiment, is Gaza under Resolution 2803.

Resolution 2803 and the Board of Peace. The resolution was adopted on 17 November 2025 by 13–0, with Russia and China abstaining. It endorsed Trump's 20-point plan, welcomed the **Board of Peace** as a transitional administration with international legal personality, and authorised a temporary **International Stabilization Force** to demilitarise Gaza. The mandates run to 31 December 2027 (UN News; UN via GlobalSecurity; Carnegie). The underlying plan gives Hamas no governing role and offers amnesty to members who give up their weapons. Day-to-day administration goes to a "technocratic, apolitical Palestinian committee", the National Committee for the Administration of Gaza (NCAG). The

plan states that "no one will be forced to leave Gaza" and that "Israel will not occupy or annex Gaza", ties IDF withdrawal to demilitarisation milestones, and promises a "credible pathway to Palestinian self-determination and statehood" once PA reforms are complete (Wikipedia).

The Board's roadmap of 30 July 2026 adopts the principle "One Authority, One Law, One Weapon", with phased, verified decommissioning and reciprocal Israeli withdrawal (Board of Peace). Trump chairs the Board with no term limit, permanent membership costs $1 billion, and the UK, France, Germany and others declined to join (Wikipedia).

Implementation has been thin. Of about $17 billion pledged in February 2026, nothing had reached the Board's World Bank account by May. A $2.45 billion six-month plan followed in September (FT; PBS/AP). Of 20,000 troops pledged, Indonesia put its 8,000 on hold (Washington Post). Israel's cabinet approved only a 200-troop pilot in a Rafah zone. Its conditions include no Israeli withdrawal before full disarmament, and they limit the committee's police to "rubber batons and tasers" (Times of Israel; Al Jazeera). A Board official said up to 500 Moroccan troops had been trained by late 2026. A single-source newsletter puts the force at about 500 from Morocco and Kosovo, with its base unbuilt pending Israeli approvals (Times of Israel; Gaza Biweekly). The NCAG, chaired by Ali Shaath, had still never entered Gaza as of 1 November 2026 (Gaza Biweekly).

Critiques. Hamas calls the arrangement "foreign guardianship", critics liken it to League of Nations mandates, and EU High Representative Kaja Kallas noted that the Board's charter omits the UN's 2027 time limit (Al Jazeera; Anadolu; Guardian). Comparative analysis notes that the UN mission in Kosovo was backed by about 50,000 KFOR troops, and that East Timor's UN administration fared better than Kosovo's (Oxford Political Review; UNU-WIDER).

Public support. Palestinian trust in the Board stood at 24% in August 2026 (PCPSR).

Feasibility. As an endgame, trusteeship is a transitional state with exit conditions. Carnegie's Zaha Hassan expects the Board to dissolve after Trump leaves office in January 2029, which could leave Israel to inherit the administration (Carnegie).

Family 5 — One state over all the land: equal citizenship or Palestinian dominance

The "one-state reality" thesis describes the baseline rather than proposing an endgame

Ian Lustick's *Paradigm Lost* (2019) and the 2023 volume *The One State Reality*, edited by Michael Barnett, Nathan Brown, Marc Lynch and Shibley Telhami, argue that "a one-state arrangement is not a future possibility; it already exists". In their account Palestinians are "permanently treated as a lower caste" (Wikipedia; Abu Aardvark). Robert Satloff of the Washington Institute called the argument "breathtakingly tendentious" for ignoring the hard borders between Israel, Gaza and the West Bank (Washington Institute). Surveyed Middle East scholars largely share the diagnosis. Only about 3% saw two states as probable within ten years, and most expected "a one-state reality akin to apartheid" if partition fails (Brookings). The thesis calls for equality but prescribes no particular design. For the game it is the starting condition.

Binationalism and the 1947 federal plan never found a mass constituency

Parity binationalism. It began as a Jewish intellectual current. **Brit Shalom** (1925), whose members included Arthur Ruppin, Martin Buber, Hugo Bergmann and Gershom Scholem, and **Ihud** (1942), led by Judah Magnes and Buber, sought one state on the principle of political **parity** regardless of numbers, with Jewish immigration regulated by that principle. The Hashomer Hatzair movement adopted binationalism in 1929 (Wikipedia: Brit Shalom; JVL; Wikipedia: Ihud). Brit Shalom never had more than a few hundred adherents (Beinin). UNSCOP, the UN's special committee on Palestine, was "impressed" but unconvinced (JVL).

Majoritarian proposals. A majoritarian one-state tradition ran in parallel. Britain's 1939 White Paper envisaged an independent Palestine within ten years, with Jewish immigration capped so that Jews would make up about a third of the population (Avalon). At the London Conference of 1946–47, Arab states proposed a unitary state with a permanent Arab majority, full civil rights for Jews who held citizenship, and a ten-year residence requirement for naturalisation (Wikipedia). Partition and war overtook all of these in 1947–48.

One democratic state pairs equal citizenship with full refugee return

Origin and proponents. The democratic-state idea began as a PLO/Fatah slogan of 1969–74: a non-sectarian state replacing Israel, with citizenship for Jews who arrived before 1947 (Palestine-Israel Journal). It then became an intellectual proposal and later a campaign. Edward Said (1999) urged "sharing the land that has thrust us together" (Wikipedia). Tony Judt (2003) called Israel "an anachronism" and proposed "a single, integrated, binational state of Jews and Arabs, Israelis and Palestinians" (NYRB). Virginia Tilley (2005) and Ali Abunimah (*One Country*, 2006) followed (Wikipedia; Wikipedia: Abunimah).

Core terms. The **One Democratic State Campaign (ODSC)** was launched in Haifa in 2018 as "a Palestinian-led initiative". Its ten-point programme calls for one constitutional democracy from the Mediterranean to the Jordan, with equal citizenship and **full return of refugees and their descendants**, whose property would be restored and/or compensated. National, ethnic and religious associations would be constitutionally protected, but "no group or collectivity" would hold privileges. The programme adds shared civil institutions and a redistributive economic policy (Mondoweiss/ODSC). The campaign frames its goal as "decolonisation". It leaves the fate of settlements to "the '67 refugees and the current inhabitants" of the West Bank, and its strategy is to "collapse Israel's apartheid regime and force Israelis to accept a transition". It leaves Jerusalem, the security forces, and any Jewish national self-determination beyond collective rights unspecified (ODSC).

Legal and ethical assessment. Equal citizenship fits non-discrimination norms, and full return follows the text of Resolution 194, which Israel reads as non-binding (Wikipedia). The key legal and ethical question is consent: a single state imposed on a people that has not agreed to it raises a self-determination problem of its own. Demographically, return of even the 2.4 million refugees registered in Jordan would produce about 9.8 million Palestinians against 7.4–7.8 million Jews and others in the area, a Palestinian majority of about 55–57%. This is a calculation from PCBS, CBS and UNRWA figures (UNRWA Jordan; Arab News/PCBS). Salman Abu Sitta argues that return is physically feasible because, in his figures, 78% of Israel's Jews live on 15% of its land (Palestine Land Society).

Critiques. Israeli critics treat full return as ending a Jewish-majority state. Benny Morris calls "secular democratic Palestine" "camouflage for the goal of a Muslim Arab–dominated polity". Shlomo Ben-Ami called it "ivory tower nonsense", Amos Elon predicted Zimbabwe rather than post-apartheid South Africa, and Hussein Ibish warned of protracted civil war (Wikipedia).

Public support. In July 2024 one equal state drew 25% of Palestinians, 14% of Israeli Jews and 49% of Arab Israelis. Once supporters of two states are removed, it falls to 8% on each side. As a Palestinian first choice it fell to 12% in October 2025 and 10% in August 2026, although 33% backed abandoning two states for one (Pulse; PCPSR Poll 96; PCPSR Poll 97).

Feasibility as of November 2026: very low. The campaign's own theory of change requires a regime collapse and a cross-national alliance, and neither exists.

A Palestinian state with limited or no rights for Jews is the mirror-image pole

Origin and proponents. Maximalist programmes envisage an Arab or Islamic state over all of Mandate Palestine. The **1968 PLO Charter** declared Palestine within its Mandate borders "an indivisible territorial unit" (Art. 2). It recognised as Palestinians only "Jews who had normally resided in Palestine until the beginning of the Zionist invasion" (Art. 6), held that "armed struggle is the only way to liberate Palestine" (Art. 9), and called Israel's establishment "entirely illegal" (Art. 19) (Avalon). The Palestine National Council voted 504–54–14 in 1996 to cancel the provisions that contradicted the 1993 mutual-recognition letters, and reaffirmed this in 1998. Critics argue that the procedure, and the absence of a new text, leave the Charter's status disputed (Wikipedia).

Hamas's 1988 charter calls for "the banner of Allah over every inch of Palestine" and declares Palestine an Islamic waqf (religious endowment). It rejects negotiations ("There is no solution for the Palestinian question except through Jihad"), quotes a hadith on killing Jews and cites the *Protocols of the Elders of Zion*. Other faiths may coexist "under the wing of Islam" (Avalon). **Hamas's 2017 document** keeps the river-to-sea claim, refuses recognition of Israel and calls refugee return non-negotiable. At the same time it describes a fully sovereign state on the 4 June 1967 lines as "a formula of national consensus", and says the conflict is "with the Zionist project not with the Jews because of their religion" (Middle East Eye). It did not formally replace the 1988 charter (Wilson Center). **Palestinian Islamic Jihad** seeks a sharia-based state across the land and rejects any settlement (Mapping Militants). A Hamas-sponsored conference in 2021, **"Promise of the Hereafter"**, recommended that Jewish fighters be killed, that others be allowed to leave or be prosecuted, and that educated Jews be retained for a time to prevent a "brain drain" (Times of Israel; MEMRI). After 7 October, Hamas official Ghazi Hamad said "We must remove that country" and that the attack would be repeated (Ynet).

Legal assessment. These programmes would breach international law on several counts. They deny a UN member state's right to "live in peace within secure and recognized boundaries" under Resolution 242 (UN), and they rely on force. Where they strip citizenship from, or expel, Jewish residents who arrived after 1917 or 1948, they would amount to deportation or forcible transfer, a crime against humanity under the Rome Statute (ICC). They also entail discrimination on national and religious grounds.

Public support. Support is significant but declining. In July 2024, **33% of Palestinians** backed a Palestinian state without equal rights for Jews, as did 17% of Arab Israelis. In the same poll, 26% of Palestinians said the long-term aim of the PA/PLO is to "conquer the state of Israel and destroy much of the Jewish population", and 64% of Israeli Jews believe that is the Palestinian aim (Pulse). Support for Hamas's decision to launch the 7 October attack fell from 72% in December 2023 to 53% in October 2025. Hamas's share of party identification fell to 19% in October 2026 (PCPSR Poll 96; PCPSR).

Feasibility as of November 2026: negligible. The outcome presupposes Israel's military defeat or collapse. Hamas's 2017 formula is better modelled as a "phased" posture: an interim state on the 1967 lines that does not end the conflict.

The comparison matrix shows where the families actually diverge

The three tables condense core terms, legal status, support and feasibility. Their sources are those cited in the family sections above. Feasibility ratings are this report's assessment of the chance that an arrangement becomes the governing reality within about a decade, judged from the veto players in place in November 2026.

Table A. Territory, settlements and security

Solution (family)	Borders and territory	Settlements	Security
1a Transfer / "voluntary emigration"	All land under Israel; Gaza largely emptied (Ben-Gvir: 1.86 million over seven years)	Expanded; Gaza resettled in far-right versions	Israeli
1b Annexation without equal rights (Smotrich 2017, Sovereignty Movement, Friedman 2024)	Israeli sovereignty over the whole West Bank; Gaza usually excluded	"Hundreds of thousands" more settlers	Israeli; "strong hand" against resisters
1c Annexation with phased citizenship (Elitzur, Hotovely, Rivlin, Glick)	Israeli sovereignty over the West Bank in stages (Area C, then B, then A); Gaza excluded	Retained	Israeli; vetting before citizenship
2a Autonomy (Begin 1977, Camp David 1978)	Sovereignty "left open"; Israeli claim kept	Israelis may buy land and settle	IDF stays; Israel keeps security
2b Enclaves and emirates (Bennett 2012, Smotrich 2025, Kedar)	Israel annexes Area C (about 60%) up to 82%; Palestinian city enclaves	Retained and expanded	Israeli overall; local forces in enclaves
2c Jordanian option (Allon; London Agreement 1987)	Jordan Valley, East Jerusalem and blocs to Israel; populated areas to Jordan	Retained in the Israeli zone	Israeli belt in the Jordan Valley
2d Conflict management, shrinking, economic peace	No change: Areas A, B and C; Israel holds 53–70% of Gaza	Continue	Full IDF control; periodic operations
3a Three-state (Bolton, Eiland)	Gaza to Egypt (Eiland adds about 600 km^2 of Sinai); remaining West Bank to Jordan	Retained in the annexed West Bank	Egypt and Jordan
3b Trump 2020 conditional state	About 70% of the West Bank plus Negev swaps; Jordan Valley Israeli	None uprooted; about 97% of settlers inside Israel	Israeli "overriding" responsibility; Palestine fully demilitarised
3c Negotiated two states (Clinton, Taba, Geneva, Olmert, Kerry)	1967 lines; 2–7% annexed with near one-for-one swaps	Blocs annexed (about 80% of settlers under Clinton); others evacuated	Non-militarised state; international force; IDF exit over 30–36 months plus a Jordan Valley period
3d Outside-in track (Arab Peace Initiative, New York Declaration)	1967 lines (Arab Peace Initiative: minor agreed swaps)	Not specified (ICJ: evacuate)	Demilitarised; UN-mandated stabilisation mission

Solution (family)	Borders and territory	Settlements	Security
4a Holy Land Confederation (2025)	Two states; 2.5% swaps; Gaza–West Bank corridor	21 annexed; 105 (about 194,000 settlers) stay as residents of Palestine	Israel leads external defence at first; international forces; Israeli air defence
4b A Land for All confederation	Two states on the Green Line; open border	Settlers may stay under Palestinian law; expansion stops	Each state at home; no IDF in Palestine
4c Jordan–Palestine confederation	Palestinian state first, then confederation with Jordan	As in the prior two-state deal	As in the prior two-state deal
4d Federation, cantons, parallel states	One federal state of 30 cantons, or two overlapping states	Remain	IDF the sole army (Federation Movement); layered (parallel states)
4e Trusteeship (corpus separatum, Holy Basin, Board of Peace)	International regime over Jerusalem or the Old City, or over Gaza until the end of 2027	Not applicable in Gaza	International force plus IDF perimeter (Gaza); joint or multinational police (Old City)
5a One democratic state (ODSC, Judt)	Single state from river to sea	Fate decided by 1967 refugees and current inhabitants	Unspecified; integrated
5b Palestinian state with limited or no rights for Jews (PLO 1968, Hamas 1988, Palestinian Islamic Jihad)	Mandate Palestine "indivisible"	Removed	Palestinian or Islamist; "armed struggle"

Table B. Jerusalem, refugees and political rights

Solution	Jerusalem and holy sites	Refugees	Citizenship and political rights
1a Transfer	Israeli sovereignty	No return; creates new displacement	Leavers lose any stake; cash incentives (GREAT Trust: $5,000 each)
1b Annexation without equal rights	Israeli, undivided	None	Residency and local vote; no Knesset vote; possible Jordanian vote; conditional citizenship later
1c Annexation with phased citizenship	Israeli, undivided	None	Gradual Israeli citizenship after vetting; Jewish-state Basic Law first
2a Autonomy	Unresolved (talks foundered on East Jerusalem)	"Reasonable volume" via a joint committee	Elected council; choice of Israeli or Jordanian citizenship
2b Enclaves and emirates	Israeli; ignored (Kedar)	Not addressed	Israeli citizenship for Area C residents (Bennett); local rule only (Smotrich, Kedar)
2c Jordanian option	Israeli, with a Jordanian custodianship role	Absorbed in Jordan	Jordanian citizenship
2d Conflict management	Status quo	Not addressed	PA autonomy; no change
3a Three-state	Israeli	Absorbed by Egypt and Jordan	Egyptian or Jordanian
3b Trump 2020	Undivided Israeli capital; Palestinian capital in Abu Dis, Kafr Aqab and eastern Shuafat; status quo plus prayer "for every faith"	No return to Israel; 50,000 to OIC states over ten years; refugee trust	Citizenship of a conditional state; Triangle towns could move to Palestine

Solution	Jerusalem and holy sites	Refugees	Citizenship and political rights
3c Negotiated two states	Divided by neighbourhood; Haram Palestinian and Western Wall Israeli (Clinton, Geneva), or a Holy Basin under no state's sovereignty (Olmert)	To Palestine, host states or third states; to Israel at its discretion (Olmert 5,000; Pulse package 100,000); compensation	Separate citizenships; end of claims
3d Outside-in track	East Jerusalem as capital (Arab Peace Initiative)	"Agreed" just solution under Resolution 194	Separate citizenships; PA elections
4a Holy Land Confederation	Two capitals; Old City a confederal open entity with joint police	Geneva menu; option in Israel at the third-country average	National vote in own state; residents otherwise equal; one-for-one residency quota
4b A Land for All	Open, shared city; capital of both	Return to Palestine; gradual residence in Israel	Live anywhere; vote in own state
4c Jordan–Palestine confederation	East Jerusalem as capital (Jordan's position)	As in the prior two-state deal	Palestinian citizenship, then confederal links
4d Federation	Federal capital (UNSCOP 1947: Jerusalem)	Citizenship in host states (Federation Movement)	Israeli citizenship for West Bank Arabs (Federation Movement); jurisdiction by person (parallel states)
4e Trusteeship	Corpus separatum, or a five-state Holy Basin board	Not applicable	City-citizenship option (1947); technocratic committee, no elections (Gaza)
5a One democratic state	Unspecified	Full return with restitution or compensation	Equal citizenship; collective cultural rights; no national privileges
5b Palestinian state with limited or no rights for Jews	Palestinian or Islamic sovereignty	Full return (2021 plan: absorption centres)	Citizenship only for Jews present before the "Zionist invasion" (PLO 1968), or coexistence "under the wing of Islam" (Hamas 1988)

Table C. Legal status, support and feasibility

Solution	Legal assessment	Latest support	Feasibility, Nov 2026	Endpoint type
1a Transfer	**Breach**: Geneva IV Art. 49(1); Rome Statute Arts. 7(1)(d) and 8(2)(b)(viii)	Israelis: 82% for expelling Gazans (Penn State, contested); 32% "practical" (JPPI)	Negligible at scale: no host state; Egypt and Jordan veto; US plan bars forced exit	Terminal, irreversible
1b Annexation without equal rights	**Breach**: non-acquisition rule and UN Charter Art. 2(4); Geneva IV Art. 49(6); CERD Art. 3	42% of Israeli Jews (2024)	Formal: low (US and UAE vetoes). De facto: advancing	Unstable terminal
1c Annexation with phased citizenship	**Breach** (annexation without agreement), though the rights problem is removed	No direct poll; the right prefers the no-rights variant	Very low	Transitional (drifts)
2a Autonomy	Lawful as a negotiated interim step; conflicts with ICJ 2024 if made permanent	No poll	Low as an endgame	Interim
2b Enclaves and emirates	**Breach** (annexing Area C or 82% of the West Bank); self-determination concerns	No poll; Hebron families rejected it	Low formally; de facto drift	Unstable
2c Jordanian option	Self-determination concerns; **breach** if it involves transfer	No recent poll	Negligible (Jordanian veto)	Not viable

Solution	Legal assessment	Latest support	Feasibility, Nov 2026	Endpoint type
2d Conflict management	Conflicts with ICJ 2024 (occupation must end); settlements breach Art. 49(6)	Implicit: 34% of Israeli Jews and 44% of Palestinians reject every option	High as a default; low as a solution	Default attractor
3a Three-state	Self-determination concerns; needs Egyptian and Jordanian consent	No poll	Negligible	Not viable
3b Trump 2020	Annexing about 30% conflicts with the non-acquisition rule; the Triangle clause raises citizenship objections	94% of Palestinians opposed (2020)	Shelved; its logic survives in Resolution 2803's pathway	Conditional
3c Negotiated two states	**Most consistent** with Resolutions 242 and 2334 and ICJ 2024; refugee caps contested	Package: 25% of Israeli Jews, 34% of Palestinians, 69% of Arab Israelis (2024); 53–56% of Palestinians on 1967 lines (2026)	Low near term; rises with a change of Israeli government and the Saudi track	Terminal (end of claims)
3d Outside-in track	Consistent with UN resolutions; recognition is a political act	142 UNGA votes; about 157 recognitions	Low to moderate as a process; no Israeli buy-in	Process
4a, 4b Confederation	Consistent (agreed changes); keeping settlers by consent departs from the ICJ's evacuation call	12% of Israeli Jews, 35% of Palestinians (2024); 14% Palestinian first choice (2026)	Low	Terminal, phased and reversible
4c Jordan–Palestine confederation	Lawful if it comes after statehood and is consensual	29% of Palestinians (2018)	Distant (only after statehood)	Add-on
4d Federation	Depends on equality and consent	No poll	Very low	Terminal
4e Trusteeship	Based on Resolution 2803; the Board's legal personality is disputed	24% Palestinian trust in the Board (Aug 2026)	Operating but stalled; sunset at end of 2027	Transitional
5a One democratic state	Consistent with equality norms; self-determination requires consent	14% of Israeli Jews, 25% of Palestinians, 49% of Arab Israelis (2024); 10% Palestinian first choice (2026)	Very low	Terminal
5b Palestinian state with limited or no rights for Jews	**Breach**: UN Charter Art. 2(4) and Resolution 242; deportation (Rome Statute Art. 7(1)(d)); discrimination	33% of Palestinians (2024)	Negligible: requires Israel's defeat	Terminal, irreversible

Read across the tables, the solutions cluster more tightly than the rhetoric suggests on some issues and split sharply on others. On security they converge: every design except the two poles keeps a demilitarised or limited Palestinian force and some Israeli or international role. The real dividing lines run through four columns: whether Palestinians get a national vote somewhere; whether settlers are evacuated, annexed or turned into residents; whether any refugees return to Israel; and who holds sovereignty over the Haram/Temple Mount.

Endgame-design inputs: eight variables, a dozen veto players and four clocks

The board starts in a hybrid, not at any named endgame

No named blueprint describes conditions in November 2026. The actual state of the world combines creeping annexation in the West Bank, through land registration, police enforcement and record settlement approvals, with PA civil rule in Areas A and B that is now overlaid by Israeli enforcement. Gaza is split by the Yellow Line under a thin international administration that has not yet entered the Strip, and partition is endorsed abroad but rejected by the Israeli government. This is the "one-state reality" with a Gaza twist, and the evidence favours making it the default attractor: the state the game falls back to whenever players fail to assemble the coalition a named endgame needs. The research notes recommend two modelling choices here. First, formal and creeping annexation should be separate tracks with different costs. Second, "international legitimacy" and "facts on the ground" should be separate meters. The 2024–2026 record shows the first rising (ICJ rulings, recognitions) while the second moves the other way, with only weak enforcement linking them (Times of Israel; Bernama).

Eight variables separate the endgames

Variable	Values, in spectrum order	Endgames it separates	Value at game start (Nov 2026)
Who holds sovereignty	Israel only; Israel plus enclaves; Israel plus Arab neighbours; two states; two states with a confederal layer; external administrator; shared single state; Palestine only	All five families	Israel de facto over the West Bank; Gaza split between the IDF (53–70%), Hamas and a nominal Board of Peace
Palestinian territorial share	0%; enclaves (Smotrich: the remaining 18%); Areas A and B (about 40%); about 70% (Trump); 93–98% plus swaps; the whole land	Families 1–3	PA civil control over Areas A and B (about 40% of the West Bank)
Franchise for Palestinians under Israeli rule	None; local only; gradual national; full in own state; full in a shared state	1b against 1c, 3 and 5a	None for the West Bank and Gaza; Arab citizens of Israel hold a record 19 seats; PA elections postponed to Sept 2027
Status of Jews in a Palestinian-majority outcome	National self-determination; collective cultural rights; individual rights only; limited by arrival date; none	4 against 5a against 5b	Not applicable at start
What happens to settlers	Expanded; annexed in place; blocs annexed and the rest evacuated; residents of Palestine (one-for-one quota); left to refugees and inhabitants to decide	Every family	About 541,000 in the West Bank plus East Jerusalem; record approvals in 2025
Refugee channel	None; symbolic (5,000); capped (50,000 abroad, up to 100,000 into Israel); return to Palestine; full return (about 5.9 million registered)	3c against 4 against 5a	Israeli ban on UNRWA in force since 30 Jan 2025 (EUAA)
Jerusalem and holy sites	Israeli and undivided; status quo with a Palestinian capital beyond the barrier; divided by neighbourhood; Holy Basin under no state's sovereignty; confederal Old City; corpus separatum; capital of a shared state; Palestinian or Islamic sovereignty	3b against 3c against 4 against 5	Israeli sovereignty claim; Jordanian custodianship of the Muslim sites
Security model	Israeli overriding; Israeli plus local police; international force and a non-militarised state; joint; integrated; Palestinian	All	IDF across the West Bank and most of Gaza; international force of about 500

Several research findings translate directly into mechanics. For **land swaps**, a slider from about 2% (Geneva) to about 7% (Olmert) covers the whole negotiated range; the Trump plan's roughly 30% and Smotrich's 82% sit far outside it (Palestine-Israel Journal; JVL). **Holy-site** sovereignty over the Haram/Temple Mount, the decisive variable at Camp David, works best as a binary deal-breaker card with intermediate options: divided, deferred, held by no state, or international (Wikipedia). In transfer

scenarios, the **voluntariness** of departure should depend on humanitarian pressure in Gaza, with legal and diplomatic costs rising as pressure rises. The ICRC's genuine-choice test makes coerced consent legally equivalent to forcible transfer (ICRC). The Holy Land Confederation's one-for-one **residency quota** of settlers against Palestinian residents is a tunable parameter. It lets settlements and refugees be traded off without annexation (ECF). Finally, the conditional **statehood "pathway"** in the 2020 plan, the 2025 plan and Resolution 2803 is undated. From 2025 it names no arbiter of readiness, which makes it a natural veto point (Wikipedia).

Each endgame has its own gatekeepers

Endgame	Who must consent or acquiesce	Blocking it now	Failure modes
Transfer	A receiving state; Egypt and Jordan; the US; an Israeli majority	Egypt, Jordan and the Arab League; the US 20-point plan; the UN	Exposure at the ICC and ICJ; destabilising Egypt or Jordan; collapse of the Abraham Accords
Annexation without equal rights	An Israeli majority coalition; the US; the Gulf states	The US (Trump, Vance); the UAE "red line"; Saudi Arabia	Apartheid litigation and sanctions; an uprising (in 2020, 58% of Israelis thought annexation could set off a third intifada; JTA)
Annexation with phased citizenship	Israeli Jews willing to accept a Palestinian electorate of about 40%; Palestinians willing to vote	The Israeli right prefers the no-rights variant; 78% of Palestinians say they would not vote	Drift toward binationalism or toward rights restrictions
Enclaves and emirates	Local elites; Abraham Accords states	The PA, Fatah and Hamas; clan rivalries	Violence against collaborators (the Village Leagues precedent)
Jordanian option, three-state	Jordan; Egypt	Both refuse	Instability in Jordan
Conflict management	No one (it is the default)	Nothing	Deterrence failure, as on 7 October 2023
Negotiated two states	An Israeli government; a legitimate Palestinian leadership with a monopoly of arms; US mediation; a Saudi or Arab payoff	The Israeli government and the Knesset's 68–9 vote; settlement facts; Hamas's weapons; Palestinian division	Leaders' time running out; spoilers; deadlock over the holy sites
Confederation	Everything a two-state deal needs, plus enough trust for open borders	Israeli Jewish support of 12%	Asymmetry between the partners; security for settlers
Trusteeship (Gaza)	The UN Security Council; troop contributors; Israel (to allow entry); donors; Hamas (to disarm)	Israeli conditions; Hamas's sequencing demand; the funding gap	Mandate lapses at the end of 2027; the Board dissolves after January 2029
One democratic state	Consent of the Israeli Jewish majority, or regime collapse under outside pressure	Israeli Jewish support of 14%; Israeli state power	Civil conflict; emigration of skilled Israelis (Gorenberg)
Palestinian state with limited or no rights for Jews	Israel's military defeat	Israeli military power; international law	Mass atrocity; expulsion

Drivers move the probabilities

Driver	Measured effect in the research	Makes more likely	Makes less likely
Violence and war	After 7 October, Israeli Jewish two-state support fell from 34% (2022) to 21% (2024); Palestinian support for armed struggle swung between 27% and 41% in 2025–26	Annexation, transfer, management	Two states, confederation
Israeli coalition	Hung Knesset of 53–48–19; Saudi sources tie normalisation to Netanyahu's exit	Two states or the Arab Peace Initiative under an Eisenkot-led government; annexation if the far right stays in government	The reverse
Legitimacy of Palestinian leaders	Fatah 22%, Hamas 19%, "none" 33%; 82% of West Bank respondents want Abbas to resign; elections set for Sept 2027	Negotiated outcomes, if leadership is renewed	All negotiated endgames, if it fragments
US posture	Blocked formal annexation (2020, 2025); barred forced exit (2025)	De facto tracks; Gaza trusteeship	Formal annexation; transfer
Saudi and regional normalisation	A regional-peace framing wins 62–65% on both sides	Two states; Arab Peace Initiative	Unilateral annexation
Settlement growth and land registration	54 settlements and 27,941 units in 2025; 58% of Palestinians call two states impractical	The one-state reality; enclaves	Two states; confederation
Packaging and incentives	Single incentives lift package support from 25% to as much as 60% among Israeli Jews, and from 34% to as much as 55% among Palestinians; naming the 1967 borders adds 10–15 points	Two states; confederation	None measured
Generational and religious drift	Two-state support is 8% among Jewish Israelis aged 18–35; 32% of Jews aged 18–34 are religious or Haredi, against 14% of those 55 and over	Annexation	Partition
Humanitarian pressure in Gaza	82% of structures damaged; about 950,000 displaced people at flood-risk sites	"Voluntary" emigration (legally coerced)	Reconstruction-based trusteeship
International legal pressure	ICJ 2024; about 157 recognitions; weak enforcement	The outside-in track; higher costs for annexation	Formal annexation
Order of disarmament and withdrawal	74% of Palestinians oppose disarming before full withdrawal; Israel says "no withdrawal whatsoever" without disarmament	The Yellow Line partition (status quo)	Exit from trusteeship; two states
Regional war (Iran)	Indonesia paused its troop pledge in March 2026	The status quo	The Gaza transition

Sources for the driver table: Pulse; PCPSR Poll 97; PCPSR October 2026; Jerusalem Post; Peace Now; France 24; Gaza Biweekly; Wikipedia: Board of Peace.

The incentive and framing results deserve particular weight, because they show that public opinion responds to the process rather than being fixed. In 2024 a single targeted incentive raised Israeli Jewish support for the two-state package from 25% to between 51% and 60%. Palestinian textbook reform scored 60%, and compensation for Jews from Arab countries scored 56%. Releasing all prisoners took

Palestinian support to 66% (Pulse). Perceived feasibility works as a hidden variable that drives support. A practical design would compute each constituency's support as a base preference adjusted by a feasibility signal, a violence term and a package multiplier.

Four clocks are already on the calendar

Four deadlines will force phase changes whatever players do. The first is Israel's coalition clock: the new Knesset was due to be sworn in on **10 November 2026**, to be followed by a government or another election (Jerusalem Post). The second is the Palestinian legislative election, now set for **11 September 2027** (PCPSR). The third is the Board of Peace's UN mandate, which expires on **31 December 2027**. The fourth is the end of Trump's term in **January 2029**, after which Carnegie expects the Board to dissolve (Carnegie). One newsletter also reports a Gaza disarmament deadline of 15 November 2026. That report is single-source, and the Board's high representative calls progress "performance-based, not calendar-based" (Gaza Biweekly).

Slower clocks run behind these. South Africa's reply in the ICJ genocide case is due on 22 November 2027 and Israel's rejoinder on 22 May 2029 (South African Presidency). Area C land registration is expected to take about 30 years, turning unregistered land into state land as it goes (Times of Israel).

What the evidence cannot yet settle

Several inputs remain uncertain and should be modelled as ranges, not point values. The last joint Israeli–Palestinian poll covering one state, confederation and annexation dates from July 2024, and Pew and Gallup did not survey Gaza in 2025–26. Estimates of Israeli control of Gaza range from 53% to 70%. Casualty figures are contested, with the Gaza Ministry of Health count below some independent estimates. Settler counts for 2026 come from a pro-settlement registry, and Olmert's offer survives in conflicting versions (6.3% for 5.8%, or 6.8% for 5.5%). The stabilisation force's size and the disarmament deadline rest on a single newsletter. The sources reviewed did not document the 2026 platforms of the leading opposition parties on Palestinian statehood, and the coalition outcome was still unknown on 6 November 2026.

Conclusion

The research changes the question a political simulation should ask. The decisive split is not between one state and two. It is between outcomes that require overriding one people's consent and outcomes that require both peoples' consent. The first group is transfer, annexation without rights, enclaves imposed from above, the Egypt–Jordan handover and the Palestinian-maximalist state. The second runs from two states through confederation to one democratic state. The first group commands the largest single constituencies on each side, 42% of Israeli Jews and a third of Palestinians, and it is the group international law prohibits. The second is lawful but lacks majorities, and its support moves 20–35 points with packaging, perceived feasibility and leadership. That inversion, with legality and popularity pointing in opposite directions and large "reject-all" blocs in between, is the core tension "The Solution" can make playable.

The second insight concerns time. The current equilibrium holds mainly because each veto player can block the others' preferred endgame more cheaply than it can reach its own. Washington blocks annexation and transfer, Cairo and Amman block any handover of Palestinians to them, Israel blocks statehood and the Gaza transition, and Hamas blocks disarmament. The levers most likely to break this equilibrium within 24–30 months are political rather than legal: the make-up of Israel's next

government, whether Palestinians renew their leadership in September 2027, the Board of Peace's sunset at the end of 2027, and whether Washington and Riyadh turn their current vetoes and conditions into positive inducements. A model that gives players these levers, and lets facts on the ground accumulate whenever no one pulls them, would reproduce the conflict's real dynamics better than a menu of named blueprints.